

Gopher Industries - Food Remedy API

SIT374 – Capstone Team project (A)

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1. Introduction

Objective and scope

The objective of this report is to provide a clear foundational understanding of common dietary restrictions and preferences. As part of the Food remedy Co API research project, the classification will serve as a knowledge base for accurately handling dietary data, ensuring that the API's functionality respects and correctly identifies various user needs.

This report categorizes dietary practices based on their underlying motivations ethical, religious, or health and summarizes the key inclusions and exclusions for each. Visual aids are incorporated to facilitate quick reference and comparison.

2. Primary motivation for dietary practices

Understanding the 'why' behind a diet is crucial for proper classification. These motivations often overlap, but they form the core of the restriction.

Motivation	Description	Examples
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Ethical	Driven by concerns for animal welfare, environmental sustainability, or personal philosophy.	Veganism, vegetarianism, pescatarianism.
Religious	Mandated by religious texts, traditions, or doctrines.	Halal (Islam), kosher (Judaism), Jainism (jain).
Health	Based on medical necessity, allergy management, or personal wellness goals.	Gluten – free (celiac disease), lactose – free, low-FODMAP

3. Classification of major dietary systems

This section details the specific inclusions and exclusions for key dietary categories.

All categories:

Diets	Category	Key inclusions	Key exclusions
Vegan	Ethical	All plant-based foods: fruits, vegetables, grains, legumes, nuts, seeds	All animal products: meat, poultry, fish, dairy, eggs, honey, gelatin, carmine.
Vegetarian (Lacto-Ovo)	Ethical	Plant-based foods, dairy products, eggs	Meat, poultry, fish, and any other animal flesh. Gelatin is often excluded.
Pescatarian	Ethical	Plant-based foods, dairy, eggs, fish/seafood	Meat and poultry.
Halal	Religious	Permissible animal (cow, lamb, chicken) slaughtered via Dhabihah, dairy, grains, fruits	Pork, alcohol, carnivorous animal, blood, improperly slaughtered meat
Kosher	Religious	Ruminant animals with cloven hooves, poultry from permitted list, fish with fins and scales	Pork, shellfish, birds of prey, meat and dairy mixed
Jain	Religious	Strict vegetarian, lentils, grains, specific fruits, dairy (traditionally)	All meat, fish, eggs, root vegetables (potatoes, onions, garlic), honey, alcohol

Gluten-free	Health	Rice, corn, quinoa, fruits, vegetables, meat, fish, dairy (unless lactose intolerant)	Wheat, barley, rye, malt, triticale, seitan
Lactose-free	Health	Lactose-free dairy, plantbased milks, all other non-dairy foods	Standard dairy products (milk, cream, soft cheeses), whey, casein

4. Conclusion

This report has classified the common dietary restrictions into three primary motivational categories: ethical, religious, and health. The visual aids demonstrate that while diets like veganism and Jainism share a foundational of non-harm, their specific exclusion differ significantly, particularly regarding root vegetables and dairy. Halal and kosher diets share structural similarities around permissible meat and the prohibition of pork but diverge critically on the separation of meat and dairy, which is unique to kosher.

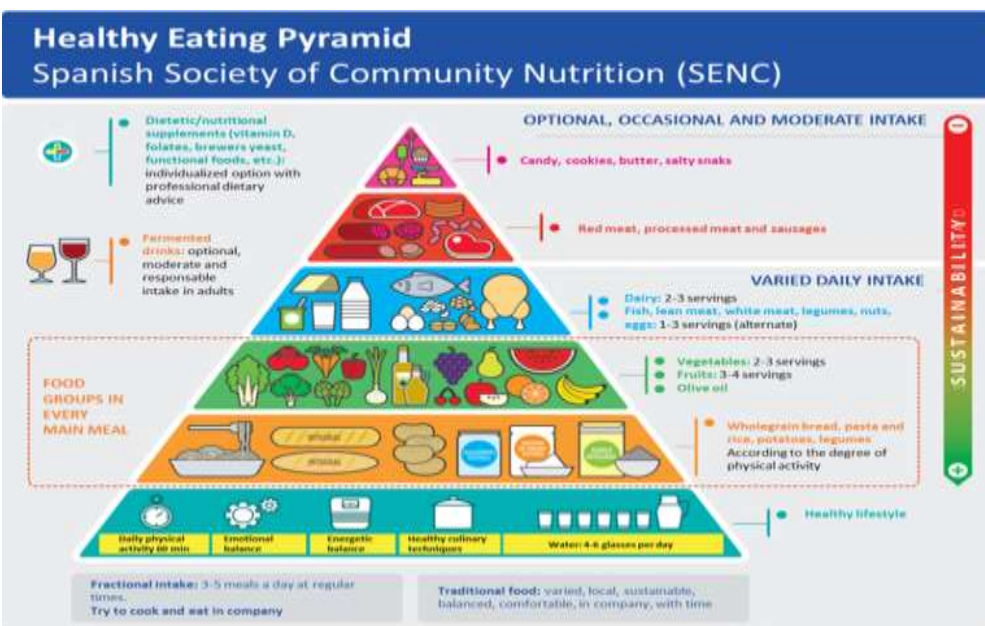
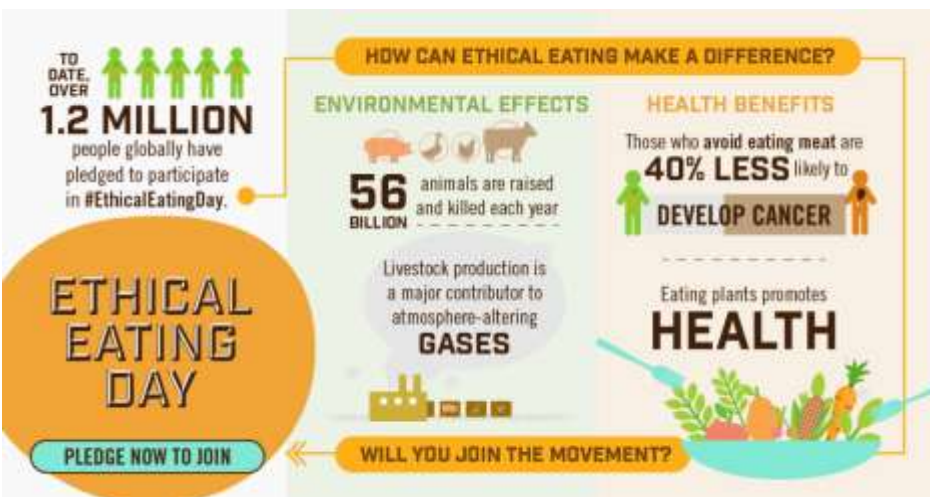
For the Food remedy Co API project, this foundational understanding is essential. The comparison matrix provides a quick reference guide for implementation logic, ensuring that the API can accurately accommodate the nuanced rules of each dietary system.

The differences between the 3 dietary requirements can be summarised in the table below.

	HALAL	KOSHER	VEGETARIAN
ORIGINS	"Halal" is Arabic, means permissible or lawful	Derived from the Hebrew word "Kashrut," which means proper or fit	Does not eat animal products, for health, moral, or religious reasons (for instance in Buddhism, Hinduism, & Jainism)
GUIDELINES	Follows Islamic Dietary Law, Based on the Quran	Follows Jewish Dietary Law, Based on the Talmud and other codes of Jewish tradition	While the typical vegetarian diet does not include meat, poultry or fish, there are variations that allow for the consumption of dairy products, eggs, and fish
SLAUGHTER	Animal must be slaughtered by a Muslim, in the name of Allah	Animal must be slaughtered by a Jew	Not Applicable
KITCHEN UTENSILS	Kitchen utensils that had direct contact with pigs or pig meat need to undergo ritual cleansing (harbi)	Kitchen utensils used to prepare non-meat food need to undergo ritual cleansing (Kashfukhush)	Good to thoroughly wash kitchen utensils that has come into direct contact with meat
PRODUCTION RESTRICTIONS	Halal products may be generally manufactured or consumed together	Meat and dairy products may not be manufactured or consumed together	Animal by-products such as beef gelatin and rennet may be included in manufacturing vegetarian products, but not virgin meat.
AQUATIC ANIMALS	Aquatic animals can be consumed	Aquatic animals that do not have scales and fins cannot be consumed	Not Applicable
ALCOHOL	Alcohol, or any food that contains alcohol, cannot be consumed	Alcohol such as grape wine can be consumed, but must be prepared according to Jewish law	Alcohol can be consumed

Information on kosher adapted from Kosher Check
Information on vegetarianism adapted from FoodOnOurVegan
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Religious-based Diets						
						
Judaism	Kosher	X	Kosher	X	Kosher	Not with meat
Buddhism	X	X		some	✓	✓
Hinduism	X	X	Restricted/Avoided		?	X
Islam	Halal	X	Halal	X		X
Rastafarianism	X	X		no fish over 12"		X
Seventh Day Adventist	X	X		X	?	
Sikh	in some sects Halal or Kosher					X



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